The post-purchase email checklist

The emails a customer gets after they buy are the most-opened emails you send, and most brands waste them on a receipt. This checklist covers the six emails to get right, in the order to fix them.

Why it matters. In Klaviyo's 2026 email benchmarks across more than 183,000 brands, automated flows generated nearly 41% of email revenue from only 5.3% of sends. Getting a customer to buy a second time costs far less than winning a new one, and it starts with the first email after checkout.

Score your order confirmation first (out of 10)

Open your last order confirmation email and give it one point for each item it gets right.

#	The email...	Point
1	Has a subject line that confirms the order and names the product, not just "Order #10234"	___
2	Opens with a human thank-you in your brand voice, not a system message	___
3	Shows the product image, what they paid and the delivery address, so they can check it fast	___
4	Gives a realistic delivery window, not "we'll let you know"	___
5	Answers the question most customers have next (sizing, setup, how to use, when to start)	___
6	Explains how to change the order or contact support, with a real reply route	___
7	Reinforces why they chose you: one line of brand story or guarantee	___
8	Does not push a discount or a hard sell before the first product arrives	___
9	Reads well on a phone: single column, large tap targets, loads fast	___
10	Is sent from a named person or a reply-able address, not "no-reply"	___

8 to 10: move on to the next email. **5 to 7:** fix the gaps this week. **Under 5:** rewrite it before anything else on this list.

The six emails, in the order to fix them

1. Order confirmation

Send: immediately after checkout

- [ ] Scores 8 or more on the scorecard above
- [ ] Sets expectations for the next email ("You'll hear from us when it ships")
- [ ] Includes one piece of useful content tied to the product they bought

> **Common mistake:** using Shopify's default template unchanged. It works, but it says nothing about your brand at the moment attention is highest.

2. Shipped and out for delivery

Send: when the order is dispatched, and again on the day of delivery

- [ ] Tracking link that works on mobile without a login
- [ ] Delivery window in plain words ("Arriving Thursday or Friday")
- [ ] What to do if they won't be home, or if something goes wrong
- [ ] For India COD orders: a WhatsApp or SMS reminder to keep the cash ready, sent the day before delivery

3. Delivered: how to get the most from it

Send: 1 to 2 days after delivery

- [ ] How to use, care for or set up the product, in three steps or a short video
- [ ] The one mistake new customers make with this product, and how to avoid it
- [ ] A direct line for help before they go to a review site or ask for a return

4. Review request

Send: once the customer has had time to use the product (days for consumables, weeks for apparel or durables)

- [ ] Asks for one thing only: a rating, with the review form inside the email if your tool supports it
- [ ] Asks for a photo, if photos help sell the product
- [ ] Sends unhappy ratings to support before they go public

5. Replenishment or cross-sell

Send: shortly before a consumable typically runs out, or when a complementary product makes sense

- [ ] Timed to your own repeat-purchase data, not a generic 30 days
- [ ] Recommends the logical next product, not your best seller
- [ ] One-click reorder link that goes straight to checkout with the cart filled

6. Win-back

Send: when a customer is past their expected repurchase date with no order

- [ ] Starts with what's new or what they'd find useful, not a discount
- [ ] Uses an incentive only in the last email of the sequence, and checks that it still leaves margin
- [ ] Suppresses customers who don't open after the sequence, to protect deliverability

Before you switch anything on

- [ ] Place a real test order and read every email on your phone
- [ ] Check each flow excludes customers who already repurchased
- [ ] Track revenue per recipient for each flow, not just open rate
- [ ] For India: decide which messages go by WhatsApp instead of email (delivery updates and COD confirmations usually do better there)

Want a second pair of eyes on your flows?

Send your store link to **@marginwise** on Instagram, or book a free 30-minute call at **marginwise.in**. You leave with your top three leaks and a written summary. No pitch, no obligation.

Source: Klaviyo 2026 email marketing benchmarks (183,000+ brands), as cited by Shopify, "How To Improve Ecommerce Customer Retention (2026)". Timings above are starting points; set your own from your repeat-purchase data. Marginwise works with D2C and Shopify brands in India, the US and the UK.